

Basically, RealNetworks editors “search the content they work with and package the most interesting clips into messages for RealPlayer users.” It’s free.

Well, that sounded a little bit like spam and a little bit interesting at the same time, so we clicked on it. We got an option to “Customize messages” and also one to download them. “Customize messages” brought up “Coming soon”—so there seems to be no way to customise your messages as of now. When we downloaded the messages, we saw eight messages with eclectic content—some of them links to trailers, a couple of them called “Best clips of the month”—you get the idea. In all the messages is a link to Rhapsody, another service of RealNetworks. (Rhapsody, by the way, is something you need to download; it includes a music organiser, and it seems to be a paid service, because you can play 25 full-length songs a month for free, while you have a choice of 1.5 million songs. Visit www.real.com for more.) The messages weren’t personalised in any way, and we suspect there’s something here about what you specify when you download or install RealPlayer. We advise you to customise your preferences at your Real.com account, such as “demographic data.” One way to get to your account is to click on the SuperPass ad and then under “More Info”, click on “My account.” Use the e-mail address and password you used when you downloaded or installed RealPlayer.

A word about SuperPass: if you sign up, you’ll get the full-featured RealPlayer Plus, and you can

- Watch full-length movies and videos
- Download full-version games
- Access a comprehensive radio guide to 5,000+ stations

Though the service is \$6.95 (Rs 325) per month, you can try it free for 14 days.

The “Globe” icon at the extreme top right of the RealPlayer window has a drop-down. The following are the items in the drop-down: